



The First War

There was a time when the gods were split into two tribes: the Aesir who lived in Asgard, and the magic-wielding Vanir who lived in Vanaheim.

One day, the wandering Vanir goddess Freya visited Asgard. At first the Aesir were delighted with Freya's magical powers and loved watching her perform tricks and spells. However, it wasn't long before they used her special gifts to advance their own petty schemes and selfish desires. This caused many arguments between the Aesir, and eventually they decided something had to be done.

But rather than holding themselves responsible for their bad behaviour, the Aesir blamed Freya instead.

Odin ordered Freya to be executed for bringing disorder to his lands. Three times the Aesir tried to burn her to death, and three times Freya was reborn unharmed from the embers. After this the two tribes grew to hate each other, and a terrible war began. The Aesir fought with spears, hammers and swords; the Vanir with spells and sorcery. Battles raged, towns were destroyed and fields became sodden with blood.

